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Huang et al.

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(54) **SEMICONDUCTOR DEVICE STRUCTURE WITH CONDUCTIVE BUMPS**

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(58) **Field of Classification Search**

CPC H01L 24/14
See application file for complete search history.

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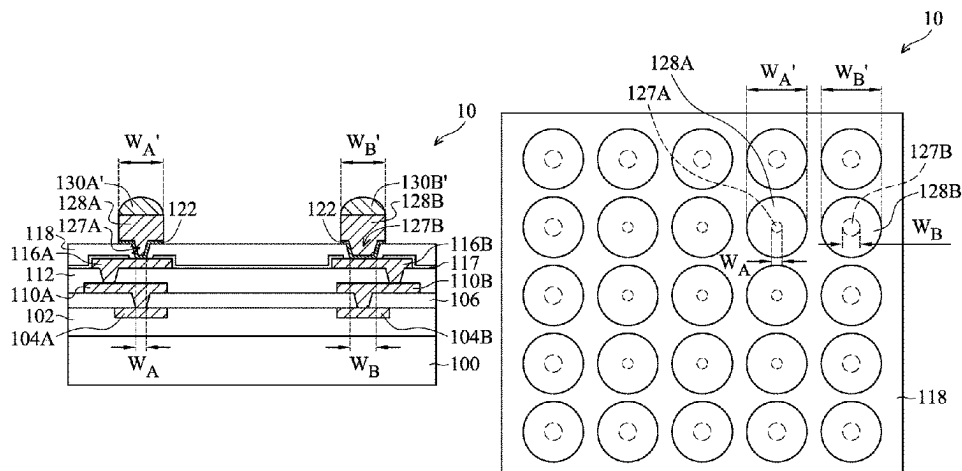
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A semiconductor device structure is provided. The semiconductor device structure includes a semiconductor substrate and a first conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate. The first conductive structure has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the first conductive structure. The semiconductor device structure also includes a second conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate. The second conductive structure is substantially as wide as the first conductive structure, and the second conductive structure has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the second conductive structure. The first conductive structure is closer to a center point of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive structure. The second protruding portion is wider than the first protruding portion, and bottoms of the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are substantially level with each other.

20 Claims, 16 Drawing Sheets



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2224/16227 (2013.01)

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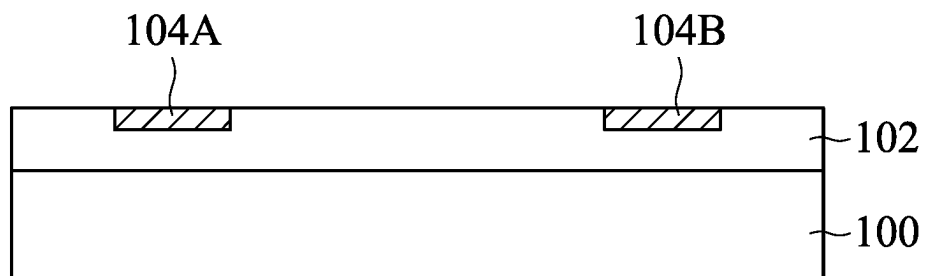


FIG. 1A

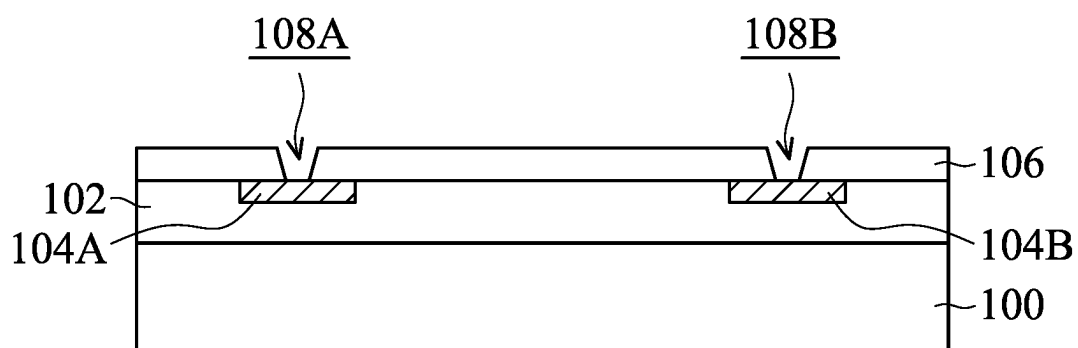


FIG. 1B

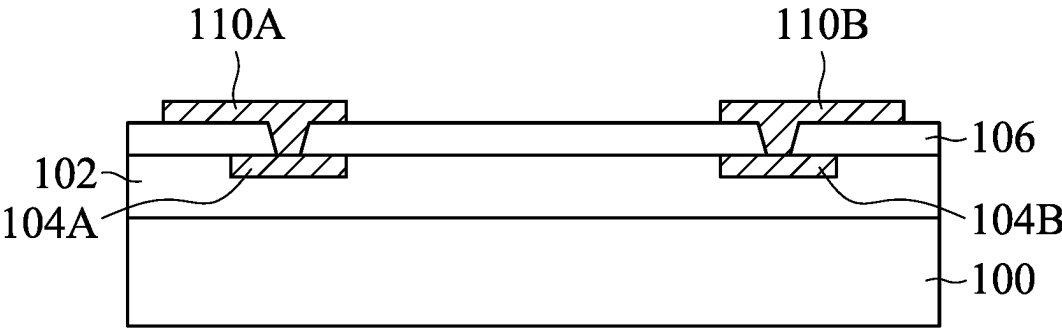


FIG. 1C

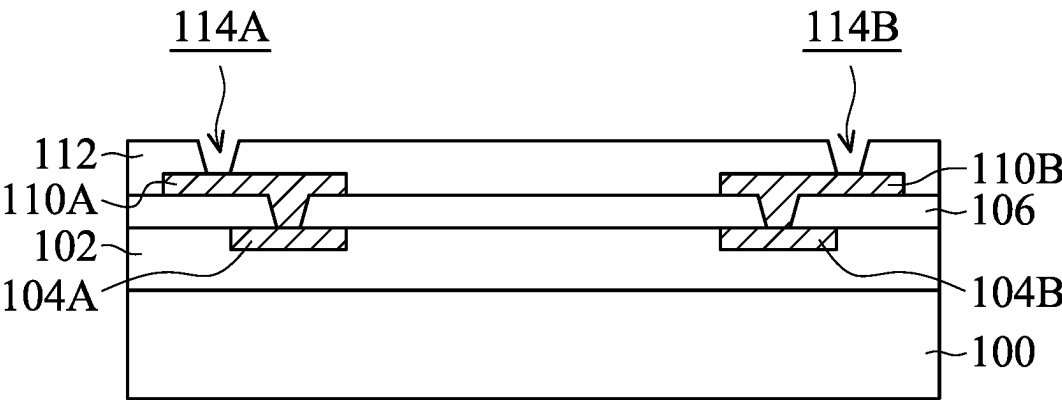


FIG. 1D

FIG. 1F

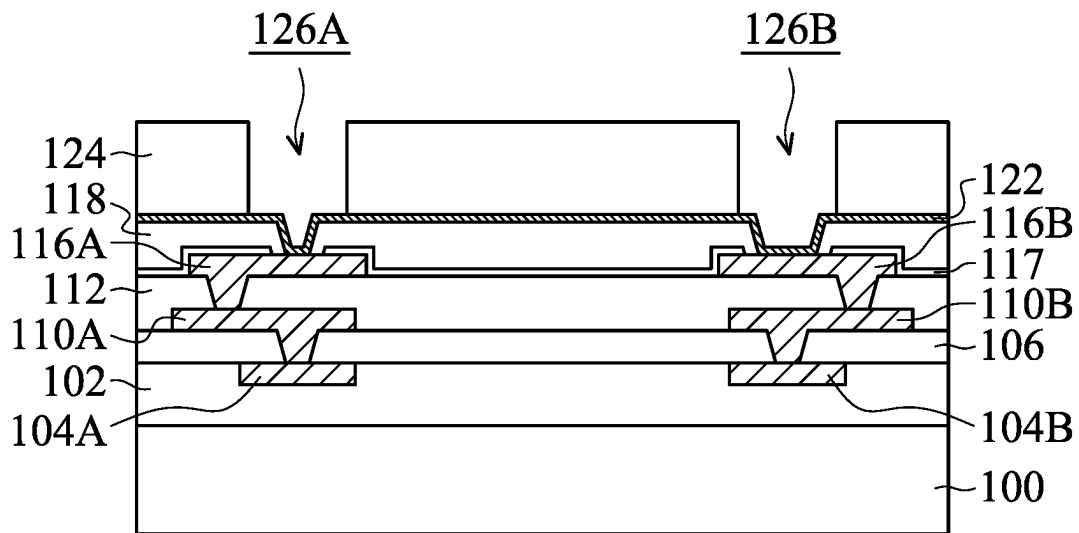


FIG. 1G

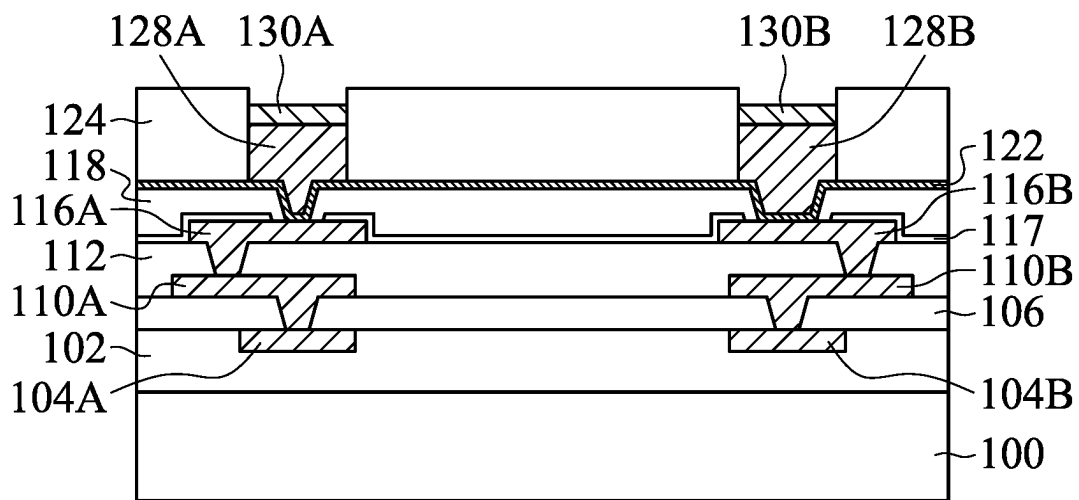


FIG. 1H

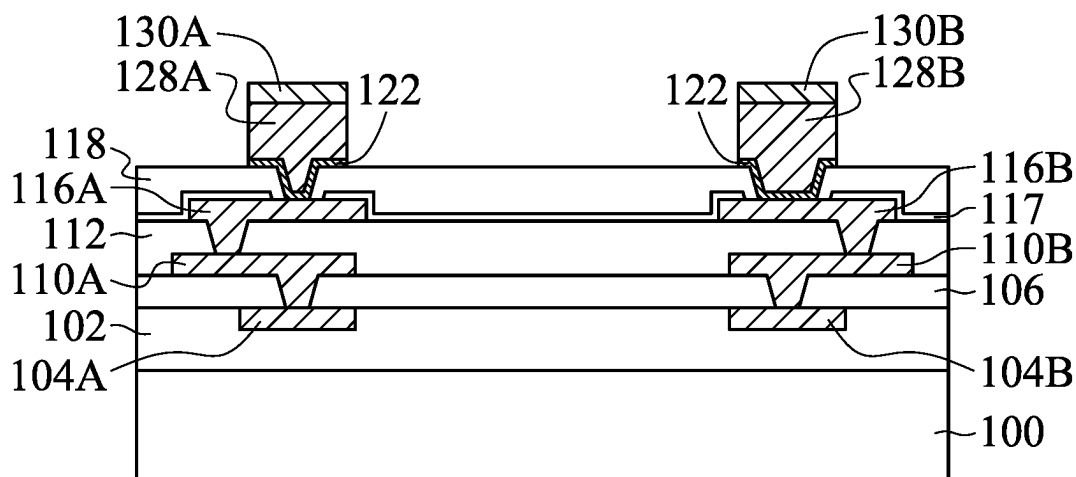


FIG. 1I

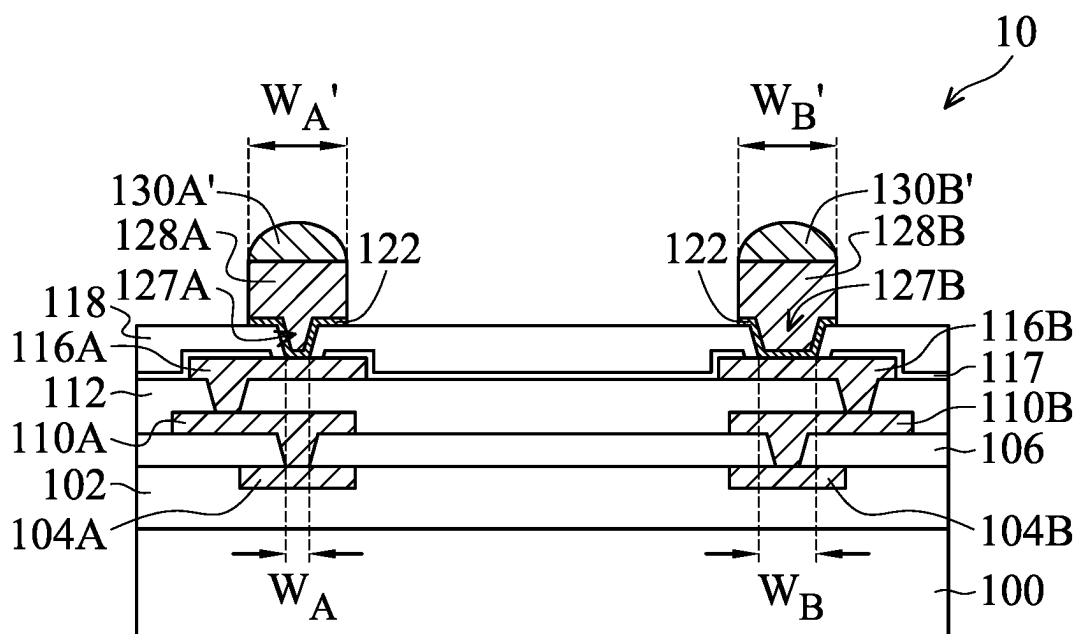


FIG. 1J

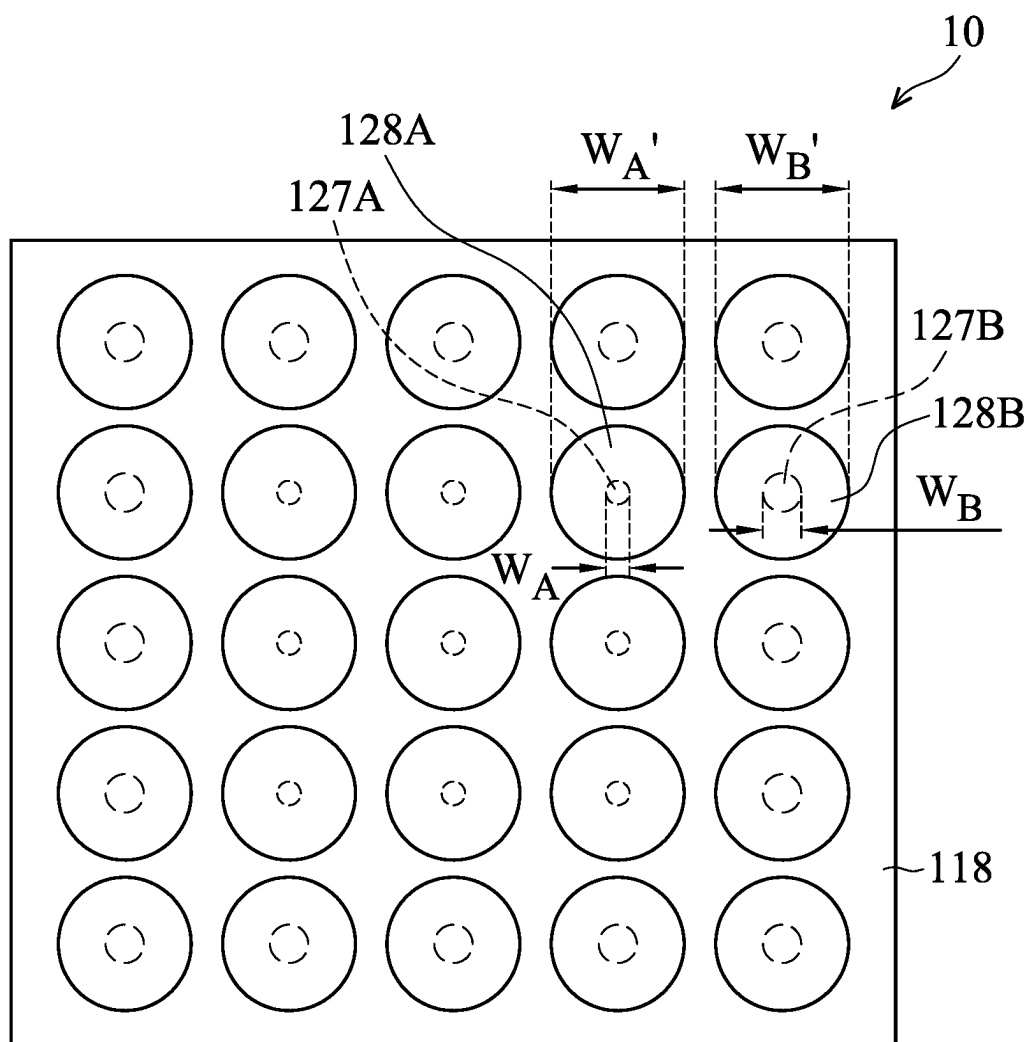


FIG. 2

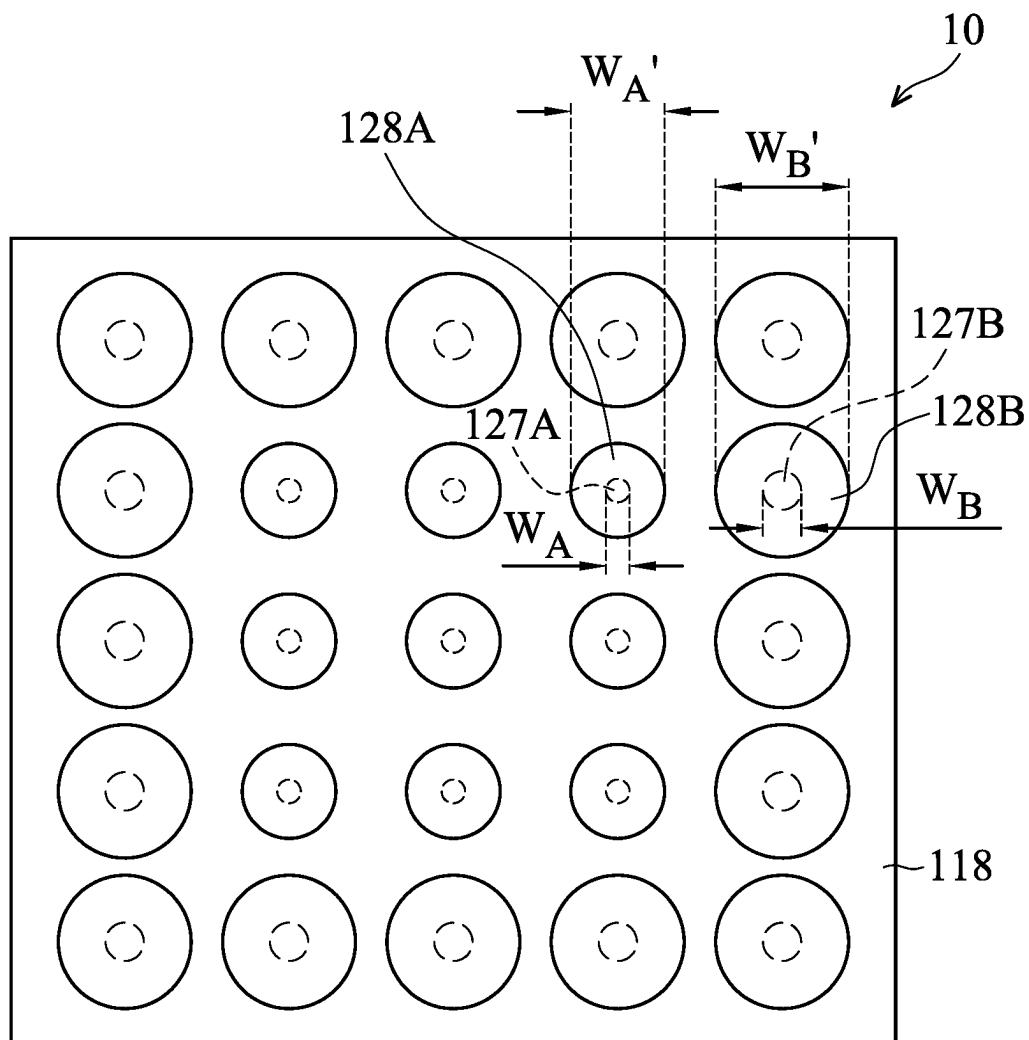


FIG. 3

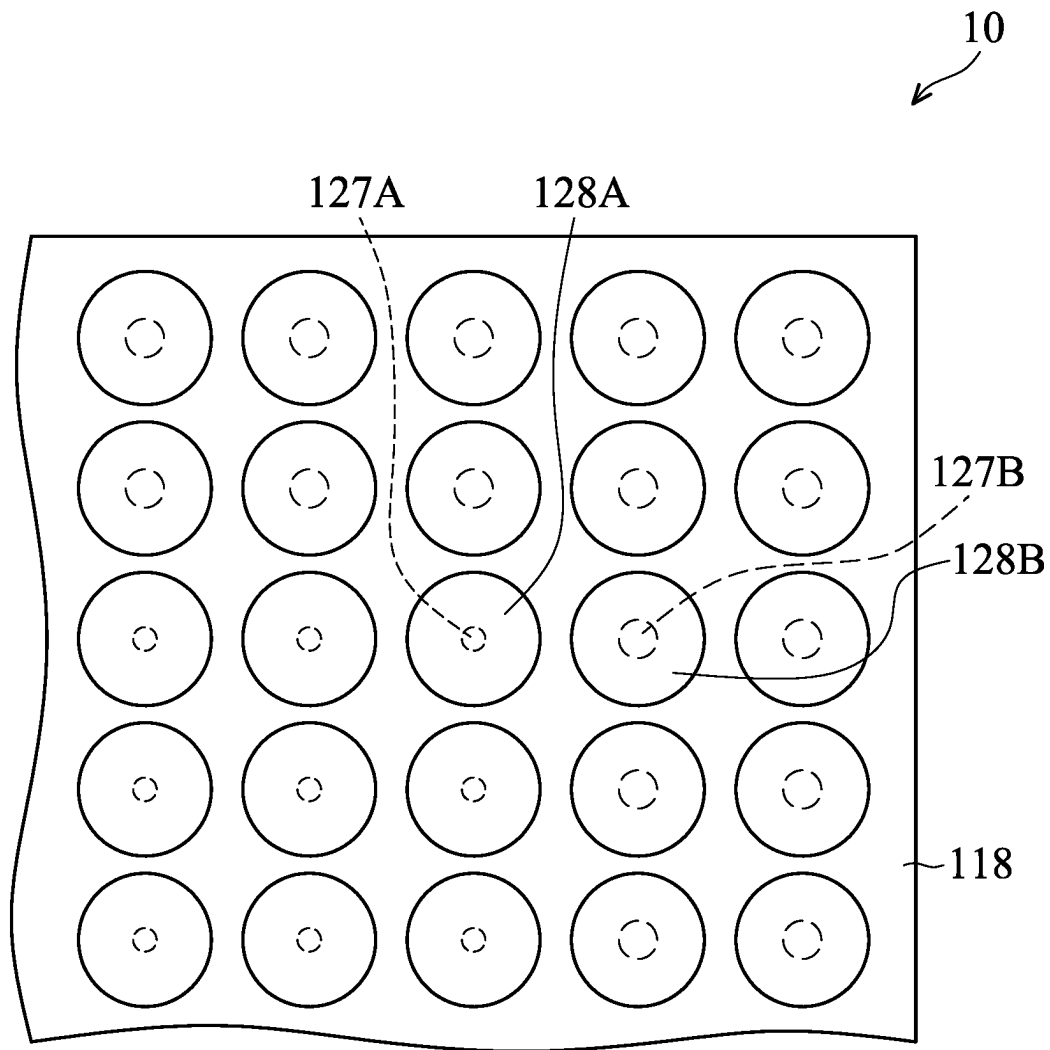


FIG. 4

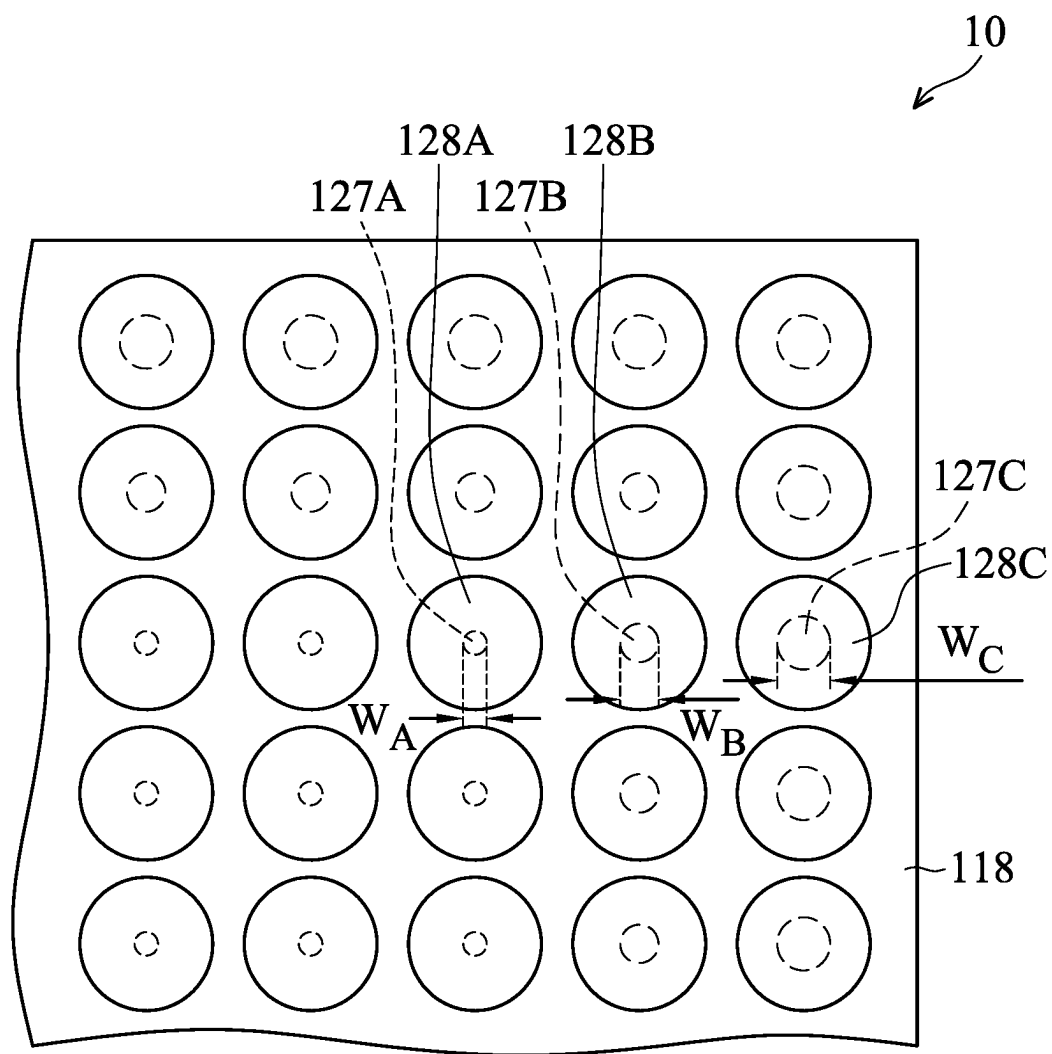


FIG. 5

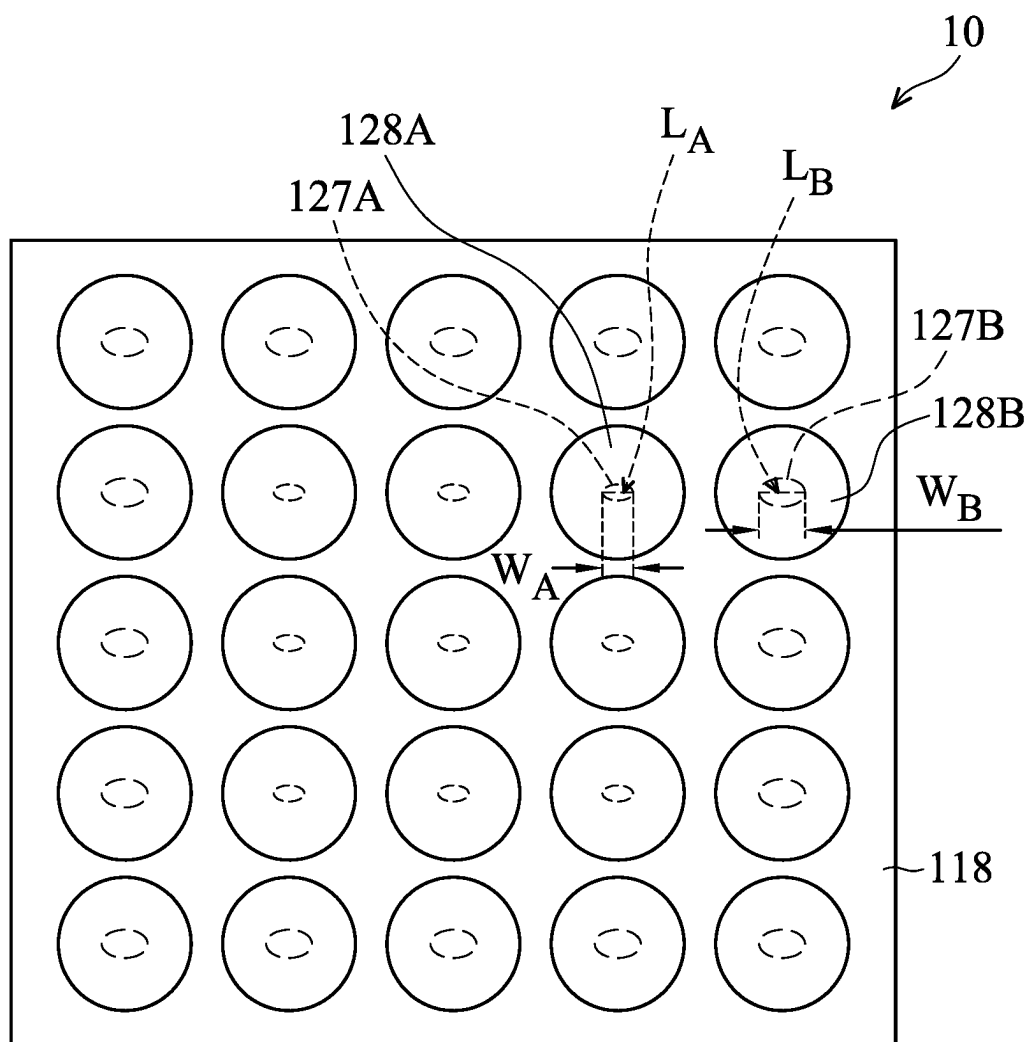


FIG. 6

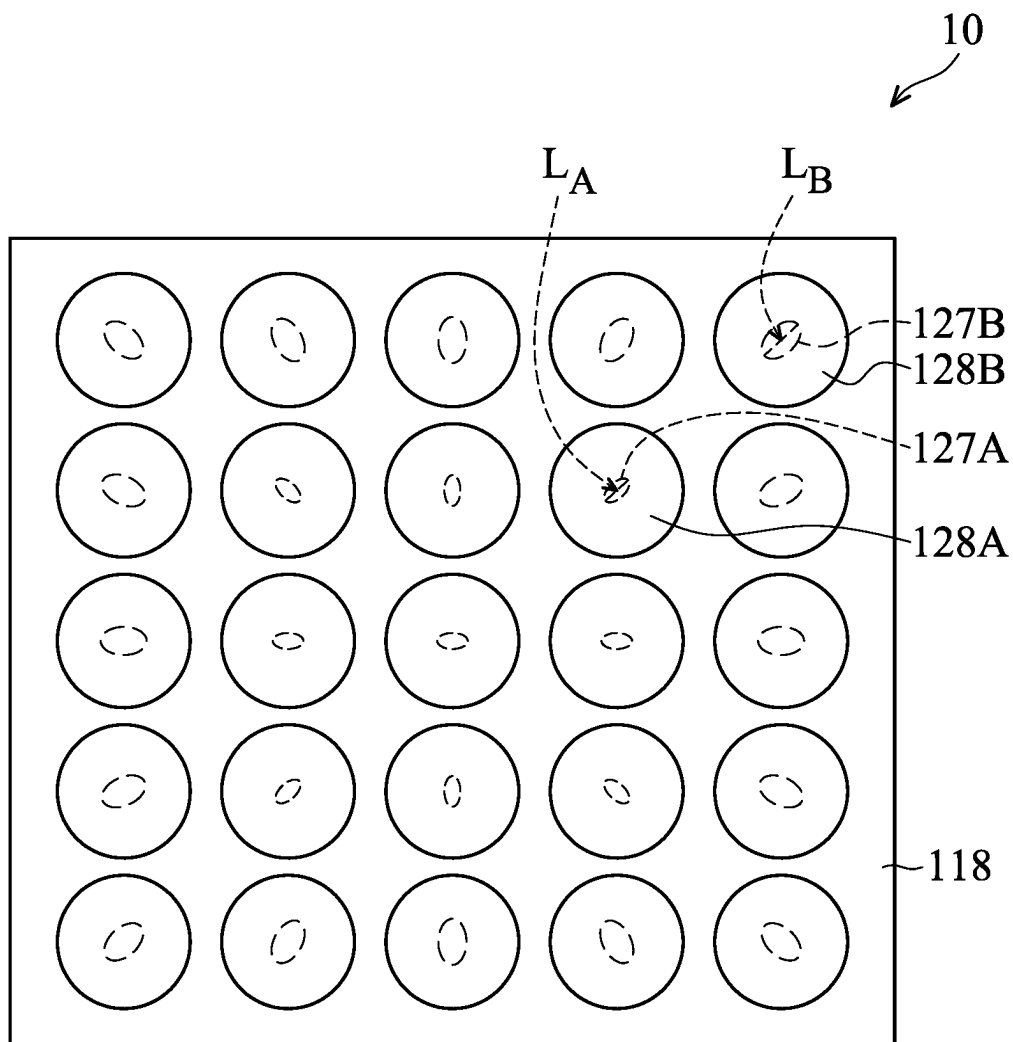


FIG. 7

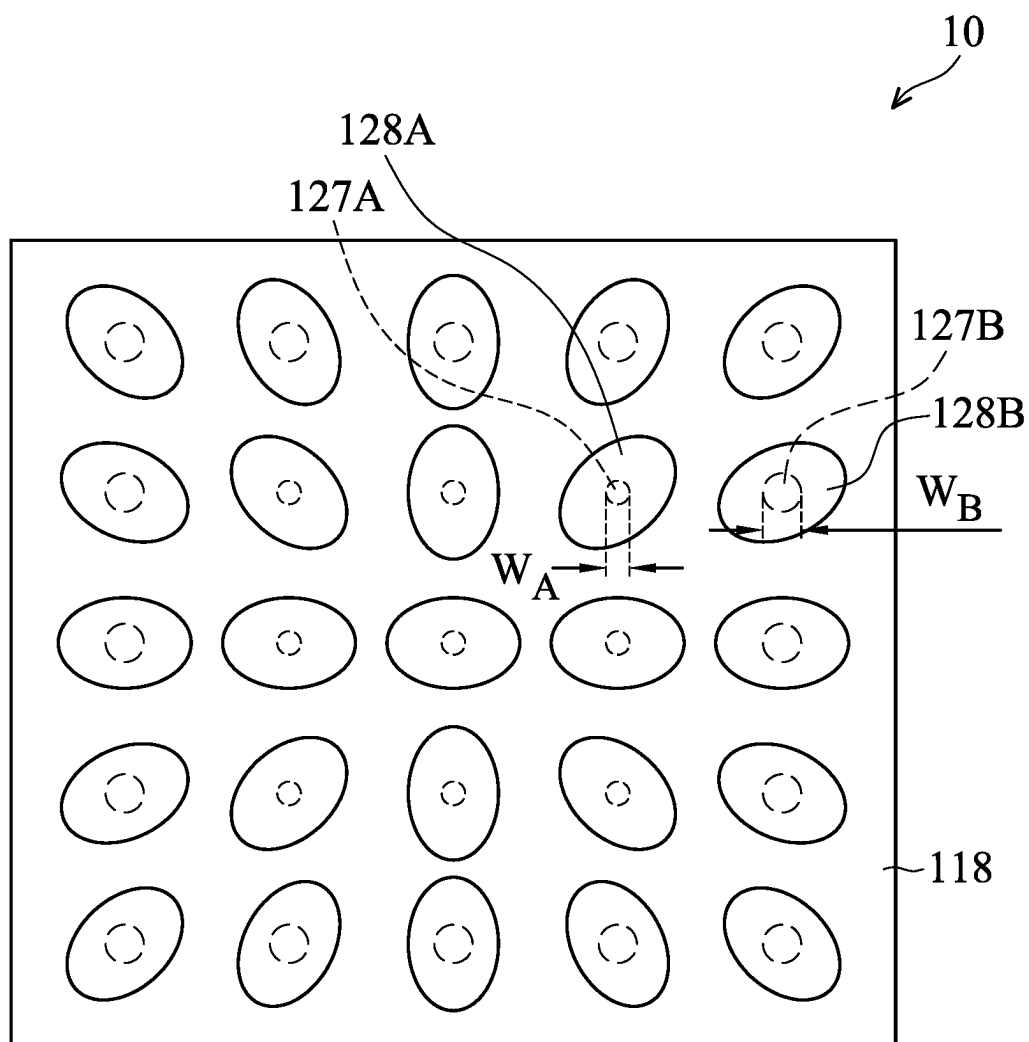


FIG. 8

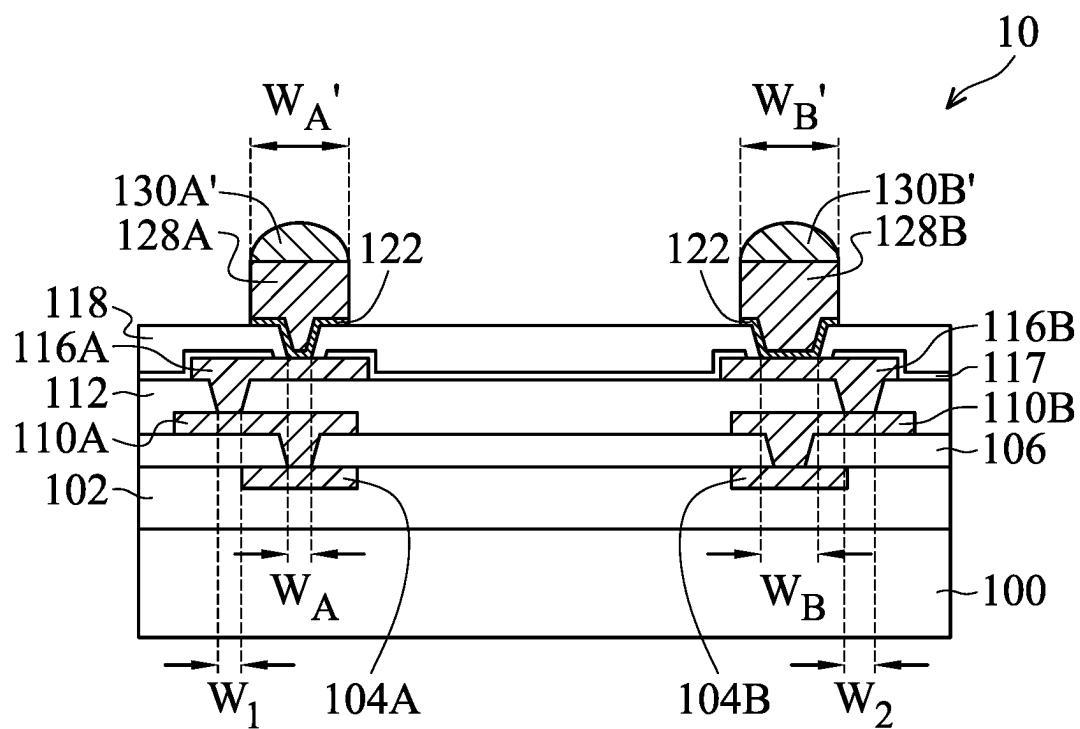


FIG. 9

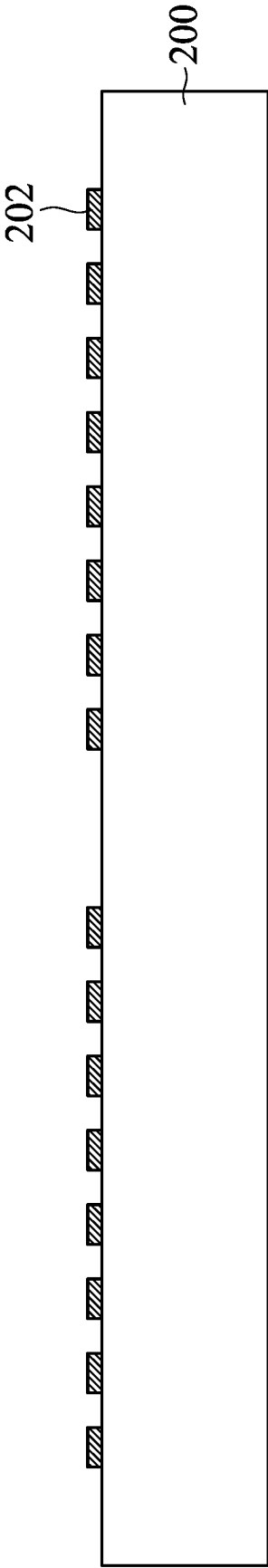


FIG. 10A

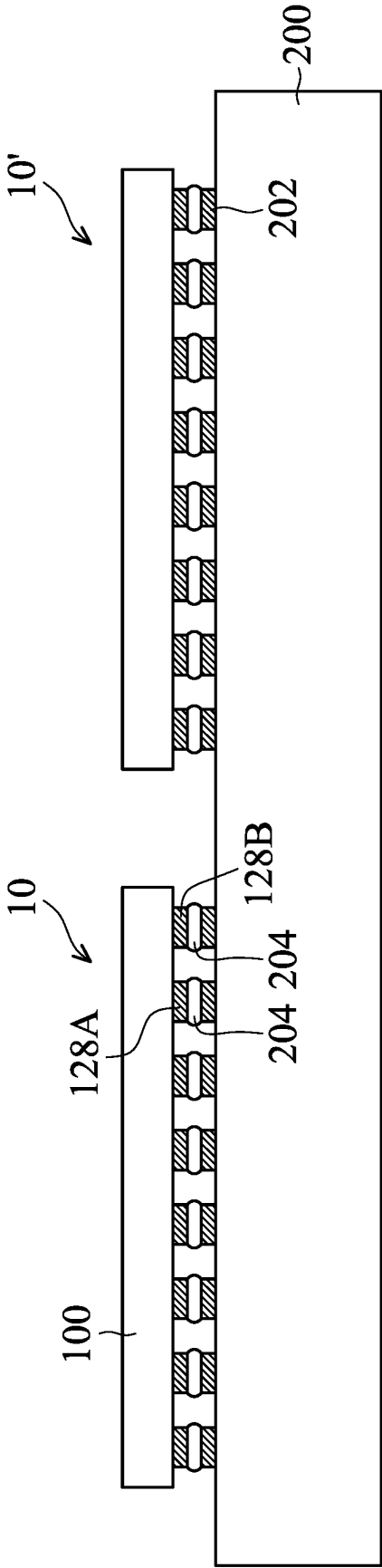


FIG. 10B

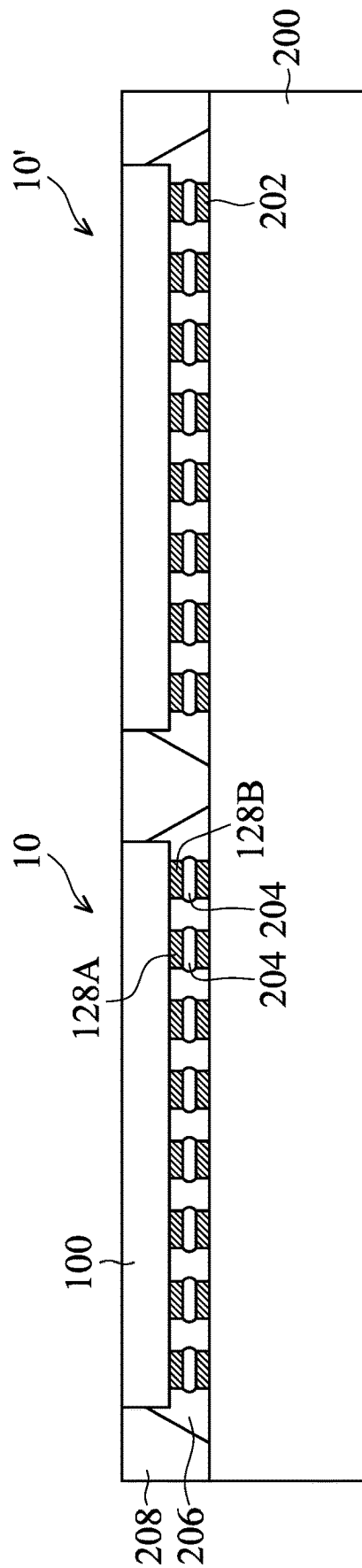


FIG. 10C

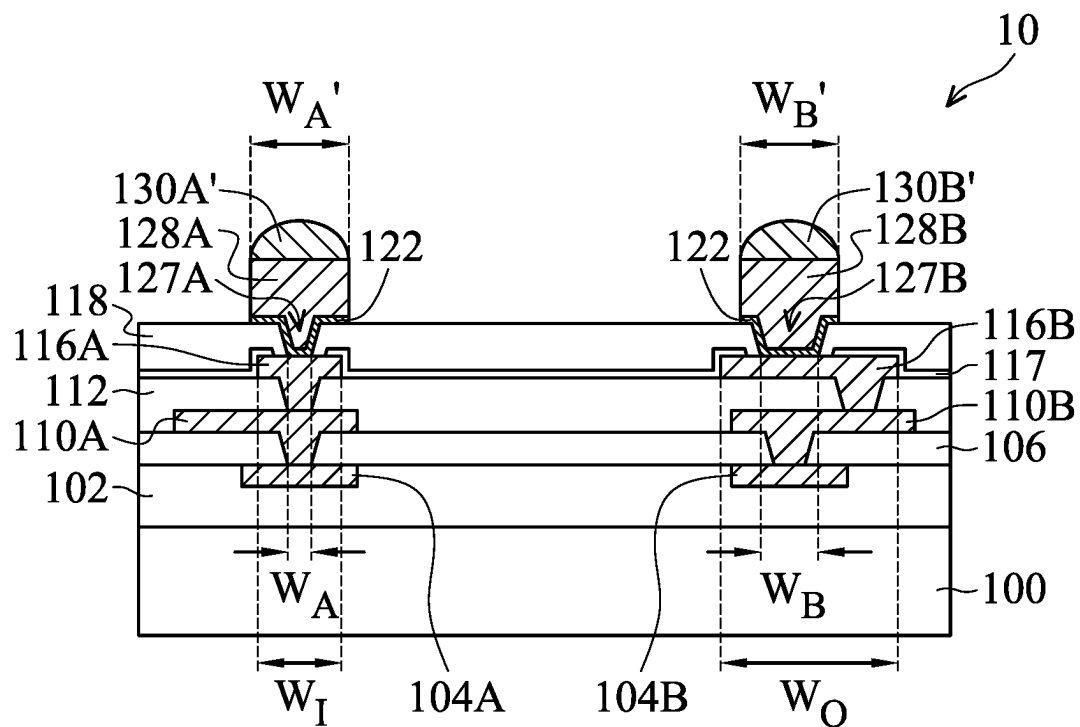


FIG. 11

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SEMICONDUCTOR DEVICE STRUCTURE WITH CONDUCTIVE BUMPS

PRIORITY CLAIM AND CROSS-REFERENCE

This Application is a Continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/459,174, filed on Aug. 27, 2021 (now U.S. Pat. No. 11,990,440), the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND

The semiconductor integrated circuit (IC) industry has experienced rapid growth. Continuing advances in semiconductor manufacturing processes have resulted in semiconductor devices with finer features and/or higher degrees of integration. Functional density (i.e., the number of interconnected devices per chip area) has generally increased while feature sizes (i.e., the smallest component that can be created using a fabrication process) have decreased. This scaling-down process generally provides benefits by increasing production efficiency and lowering associated costs.

A chip package not only provides protection for semiconductor devices from environmental contaminants, but also provides a connection interface for the semiconductor devices packaged therein. Smaller package structures, which take up less space or are lower in height, have been developed to package the semiconductor devices.

New packaging technologies have been developed to further improve the density and functionality of semiconductor dies. These relatively new types of packaging technologies for semiconductor dies face manufacturing challenges.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

Aspects of the present disclosure are best understood from the following detailed description when read with the accompanying figures. It should be noted that, in accordance with the standard practice in the industry, various features are not drawn to scale. In fact, the dimensions of the various features may be arbitrarily increased or reduced for clarity of discussion.

FIGS. 1A-1J are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 2 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 3 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 4 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 5 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 6 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 7 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 8 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

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FIG. 9 is a cross-sectional view of a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIGS. 10A-10C are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a portion of a package structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 11 is a cross-sectional view of a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

The following disclosure provides many different embodiments, or examples, for implementing different features of the provided subject matter. Specific examples of components and arrangements are described below to simplify the present disclosure. These are, of course, merely examples and are not intended to be limiting. For example, the formation of a first feature over or on a second feature in the description that follows may include embodiments in which the first and second features are formed in direct contact, and may also include embodiments in which additional features may be formed between the first and second features, such that the first and second features may not be in direct contact. In addition, the present disclosure may repeat reference numerals and/or letters in the various examples. This repetition is for the purpose of simplicity and clarity and does not in itself dictate a relationship between the various embodiments and/or configurations discussed.

Further, spatially relative terms, such as “beneath,” “below,” “lower,” “above,” “upper” and the like, may be used herein for ease of description to describe one element or feature’s relationship to another element(s) or feature(s) as illustrated in the figures. The spatially relative terms are intended to encompass different orientations of the device in use or operation in addition to the orientation depicted in the figures. The apparatus may be otherwise oriented (rotated 90 degrees or at other orientations) and the spatially relative descriptors used herein may likewise be interpreted accordingly.

The term “substantially” in the description, such as in “substantially flat” or in “substantially coplanar”, etc., will be understood by the person skilled in the art. In some embodiments the adjective substantially may be removed. Where applicable, the term “substantially” may also include embodiments with “entirely”, “completely”, “all”, etc. Where applicable, the term “substantially” may also relate to 90% or higher of what is specified, such as 95% or higher, especially 99% or higher, including 100%. Furthermore, terms such as “substantially parallel” or “substantially perpendicular” are to be interpreted as not to exclude insignificant deviation from the specified arrangement and may include for example deviations of up to 10 degrees. The word “substantially” does not exclude “completely” e.g. a composition which is “substantially free” from Y may be completely free from Y.

Terms such as “about” in conjunction with a specific distance or size are to be interpreted so as not to exclude insignificant deviation from the specified distance or size and may include for example deviations of up to 10%. The term “about” in relation to a numerical value x may mean $x \pm 5$ or 10%.

Some embodiments of the disclosure are described. Additional operations can be provided before, during, and/or after the stages described in these embodiments. Some of the stages that are described can be replaced or eliminated for different embodiments. Additional features can be added to

the semiconductor device structure and/or the package structure. Some of the features described below can be replaced or eliminated for different embodiments. Although some embodiments are discussed with operations performed in a particular order, these operations may be performed in another logical order.

Embodiments of the disclosure may relate to chip package, such as three-dimensional (3D) packaging or 3D-IC devices. Other features and processes may also be included. For example, testing structures may be included to aid in the verification testing of the 3D packaging or 3D-IC devices. The testing structures may include, for example, test pads formed in a redistribution layer or on a substrate that allows the testing of the 3D packaging or 3D-IC, the use of probes and/or probe cards, and the like. The verification testing may be performed on intermediate structures as well as the final structure. Additionally, the structures and methods disclosed herein may be used in conjunction with testing methodologies that incorporate intermediate verification of known good dies to increase the yield and decrease costs.

The via area of one peripheral conductive pillar (one opening area of the insulating layer) is larger than via area of one central conductive pillar. The larger via area may help to reduce the stress near the corner conductive pillars and/or help to sustain the warpage stress. Cracks and/or delamination are thus prevented or reduced.

FIGS. 1A-1J are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 1A, a semiconductor substrate **100** is provided. In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** is defined to mean a construction comprising one or more semiconductor materials. In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** includes a semiconductor wafer (such as a silicon wafer) or a portion of a semiconductor wafer. In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** includes an elementary semiconductor material including silicon or germanium in a single crystal, polycrystal, or amorphous structure. In some other embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** includes a compound semiconductor, such as silicon carbide, gallium arsenide, gallium phosphide, indium phosphide, indium arsenide, an alloy semiconductor, such as SiGe, GaAsP, AlInAs, AlGaAs, GaInAs, GaInP, GaInAsP, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** includes multi-layer semiconductors, a semiconductor on insulator (SOI) (such as silicon on insulator or germanium on insulator), or a combination thereof.

In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** includes isolation features (not shown). The isolation features may define and isolate various device elements (not shown) formed in and/or on the semiconductor substrate **100**. The isolation features include shallow trench isolation (STI) features, local oxidation of silicon (LOCOS) features, other suitable isolation features, or a combination thereof.

Examples of the various device elements, which may be formed in and/or on the semiconductor substrate **100**, include transistors (e.g., metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistors (MOSFET), complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS) transistors, bipolar junction transistors (BJT), high voltage transistors, high frequency transistors, p-channel and/or n-channel field effect transistors (PFETs/NFETs), etc.), diodes, one or more other suitable elements, or a combination thereof.

Various processes are performed to form the various device elements, which include, for example, deposition, photolithography, etching, implantation, annealing, planar-

ization, and/or other applicable processes. In some embodiments, the various device elements are interconnected to form an integrated circuit device. The integrated circuit device includes, for example, a logic device, a memory device (such as static random access memory (SRAM) and/or dynamic static random access memory (DRAM)), radio frequency (RF) device, input/output (I/O) device, system-on-chip (SoC) device, other applicable devices, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1A, an interconnection structure **102** is formed over the semiconductor substrate **100**, in accordance with some embodiments. The interconnection structure **102** includes multiple dielectric layers and various conductive features surrounded by the dielectric layers. The conductive features include, for example, multiple horizontal interconnects, such as conductive lines, and multiple vertical interconnects, such as conductive vias and conductive contacts. The conductive features form conductive paths between the device elements (not shown) formed in and/or on the semiconductor substrate **100**. The formation of the interconnection structure **102** may involve multiple deposition processes, multiple patterning processes, and multiple planarization processes.

Some of the conductive features of the interconnection structure **102** are shown in FIG. 1A. As shown in FIG. 1A, conductive features **104A** and **104B** that may function as top metal layers are illustrated. The conductive features **104A** and **104B** are used to provide electrical connections to conductive pillars that will be formed over the conductive features **104A** and **104B** later. The conductive features **104A** and **104B** may be made of or include copper, aluminum, gold, one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the conductive feature **104B** is formed over an outer region (or an edge region) of the semiconductor substrate **100**, and the conductive feature **104A** is formed over an inner region of the semiconductor substrate **100**. The conductive feature **104B** is closer to an edge of the semiconductor substrate **100**. The conductive feature **104A** is closer to the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor substrate **100** than the conductive feature **104B**.

As shown in FIG. 1B, a passivation layer **106** is formed over the interconnection structure **102**, in accordance with some embodiments. The passivation layer **106** may be used to protect the interconnection structure **102**. The passivation layer **106** may be made of a dielectric material. The dielectric material may be made of or include silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, silicon carbide, one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. Alternatively, the passivation layer **106** may be made of or include an organic material. The organic material may include polyimide (PI), polybenzoxazole (PBO), benzocyclobutene (BCB), one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. The organic material may be photosensitive. The passivation layer **106** may be formed using a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process, a spin coating process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1B, the passivation layer **106** is partially removed to form openings **108A** and **108B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The openings **108A** and **108B** expose the conductive features **104A** and **104B**, respectively. In some embodiments where the passivation layer **106** is made of a dielectric layer such as silicon nitride or silicon oxynitride, the openings **108A** and **108B** is formed using a photolithography process and an etching process. In some other embodiments where the passivation layer **106** is made

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of a photosensitive polymer material such as PI or PBO, the openings **108A** and **108B** is formed using a photolithography process.

As shown in FIG. 1C, conductive features **110A** and **110B** are formed, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive features **110A** and **110B** extend into the openings **108A** and **108B** to form respective electrical connections to the conductive features **104A** and **104B**, as shown in FIG. 1C. The conductive features **110A** and **110B** may be made of or include copper, aluminum, gold, cobalt, titanium, one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. The conductive features **110A** and **110B** may be formed using an electroplating process, an electroless plating process, a CVD process, a PVD process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof. The formation of the conductive features **110A** and **110B** may further involve one or more patterning processes and/or one or more etching processes.

As shown in FIG. 1D, an insulating layer **112** is formed over the passivation layer **106** and the conductive features **110A** and **110B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The material and formation method of the insulating layer **112** may be the same as or similar to those of the passivation layer **106**. For example, the insulating layer **112** is made of or include PI, PBO, one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1D, the insulating layer **112** is partially removed to form openings **114A** and **114B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The openings **114A** and **114B** expose the conductive features **110A** and **110B**, respectively. In some embodiments, the openings **114A** and **114B** are misaligned with the openings **108A** and **108B** previously formed in the passivation layer **106**. The misalignment arrangement of the upper openings and the lower openings may help to reduce stress applied on the conductive vias that are formed in these openings.

In some embodiments, the insulating layer **112** is made of a photosensitive polymer material. In these cases, the openings **114A** and **114B** may be formed using a photolithography processes. In some other embodiments, the insulating layer **112** is made of a dielectric material such as silicon nitride, silicon oxynitride, and/or silicon oxide. In these cases, the openings **114A** and **114B** may be formed using a photolithography process and an etching process.

As shown in FIG. 1E, conductive features **116A** and **116B** are formed over the conductive features **110A** and **110B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive features **116A** and **116B** respectively extend into the openings **114A** and **114B** to form respective electrical connections to the conductive features **110A** and **110B**, as shown in FIG. 1E. The conductive features **116A** and **116B** may function as conductive pads that are used to receive or hold conductive bumps that will be formed later. The material and formation method of the conductive features **116A** and **116B** may be the same as or similar to those of the conductive features **110A** and **110B**. In some embodiments, the conductive features **116A** and **116B** are substantially as wide as each other. In some other embodiments, the conductive feature **116B** is wider than the conductive feature **116A**. The conductive feature **116B** (that is wider) may have a greater strength to sustain higher stress at the edge region.

The conductive features **116A** and **116B** are electrically connected to the conductive features **104A** and **104B**, respectively. The conductive features **110A** and **110B** may be used for routing. The electrical path may thus be redistributed. In some other embodiments, more levels of conductive features may be formed for routing. In some other

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embodiments, the conductive features **116A** and **116B** are formed directly on the conductive features **104A** and **104B**. In some cases, no other conductive feature is formed between the conductive feature **104A** (or **104B**) and the conductive feature **116A** (or **116B**) that may function as a conductive pad.

As shown in FIG. 1E, the portion of the conductive feature **110A** filling the

opening **108A** forms a lower conductive via, and the portion of the conductive feature **116A** filling the opening **114A** forms an upper conductive via. In some embodiments, the lower conductive via is misaligned with the upper conductive via. In a subsequent bonding process, the applied bonding force may thus be prevented from being concentrated at the conductive vias. The reliability and performance of the semiconductor device structure are improved.

As shown in FIG. 1F, a patterned protection layer **117** is formed over the insulating layer **112** and the conductive features **116A** and **116B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The patterned protection layer **117** has openings that partially expose the conductive features **116A** and **116B** thereunder. The material and formation method of the protection layer **117** may be the same as or similar to those of the passivation layer **106**.

However, embodiments of the disclosure are not limited thereto. Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. In some other embodiments, the protection layer **117** is not formed.

As shown in FIG. 1F, an insulating layer **118** is formed over the protection layer **117** and the conductive features **116A** and **116B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The material and formation method of the insulating layer **118** may be the same as or similar to those of the insulating layer **112**.

Afterwards, the insulating layer **118** is partially removed to form openings **120A** and **120B**, as shown in FIG. 1F in accordance with some embodiments. The openings **120A** and **120B** expose the conductive features **116A** and **116B**, respectively. The top views of the openings **120A** and **120B** may have circular profiles, oval profiles, rectangular profiles, square profiles, or the like. The formation of the openings **120A** and **120B** may be the same as or similar to the openings **114A** and **114B** as illustrated in FIG. 1D. In some embodiments, the openings **120A** and **120B** are formed simultaneously. For example, a photolithography process is used to form the openings **120A** and **120B** at the same time. In some other embodiments, the openings **120A** and **120B** are formed separately using separate patterning processes.

In some embodiments, the opening **120B** is wider than the opening **120A**, as shown in FIG. 1F. Therefore, the exposed area of the conductive feature **116B** is larger than the exposed area of the conductive feature **116A**. As shown in FIG. 1F, the exposed area of the conductive feature **116A** has a width W_A , and the exposed area of the conductive feature **116B** has a width W_B . The width W_A may be in a range from about 10 nm to about 100 μm . The width W_B may be in a range from about 10 nm to about 450 μm . The ratio (W_A/W_B) of the width W_A to the width W_B may be in a range from about 0.01 to about 1. In some embodiments, the width W_B is greater than the width W_A . In some other embodiments, the ratio (W_A/W_B) of the width W_A to the width W_B is in a range from about 0.05 to about 0.95.

As shown in FIG. 1G, an under-bump metallization (UBM) layer **122** is deposited over the insulating layer **118** and the conductive features **116A** and **116B**, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the UBM

layer **122** is a single layer or a stack of multiple layers. For example, the UBM layer **122** may be made of or include Ti, TiW, TiCu, Ni, Cu, one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the UBM layer **122** includes sub-layers including, for example, a glue layer (or a diffusion barrier layer) and a seed layer.

In some embodiments, the glue layer is made of or includes titanium nitride (TiN), titanium (Ti), tantalum (Ta), tantalum nitride (Ta₂N₃), one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the seed layer is a copper-containing seed layer formed on the glue layer. The copper-containing seed layer may be made of or include pure copper or one of many copper alloys that include silver, chromium, nickel, tin, gold, one or more other suitable elements, or a combination thereof.

In some embodiments, the UBM layer **122** is deposited by using a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process (including, for example, a sputtering process or an evaporation process), a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process, an atomic layer deposition (ALD) process, an electroless plating process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

Afterwards, a mask layer **124** is formed over the UBM layer **122**, as shown in FIG. 1G in accordance with some embodiments. The mask layer **124** is used to define the positions where conductive bumps (such as conductive pillars) will be formed later. In some embodiments, the mask layer **124** is a photoresist layer, a dry film, one or more other suitable films, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the mask layer **124** is deposited using a spin coating process, a spray coating process, a CVD process, an attachment process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1G, the mask layer **124** is patterned to form openings **126A** and **126B**. The opening **126A** exposes a first portion of the UBM layer **122** above the conductive feature **116A**, and the opening **126B** exposes a second portion of the UBM layer **122** above the conductive feature **116B**. The openings **126A** and **126B** may define the shapes and sizes of conductive pillars that will be formed in the openings **126A** and **126B** later. In some embodiments, the opening **126A** is substantially as wide as the opening **126B**, as shown in FIG. 1G. In some embodiments, the mask layer **124** is patterned using a photolithography process involving one or more masking, exposing, baking, developing, and rinsing processes (not necessarily in that order).

As shown in FIG. 1H, a conductive material is deposited over the UBM layer **122** exposed by the openings **126A** and **126B** of the mask layer **124**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive material forms conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, as shown in FIG. 1H. In some embodiments, the conductive pillar **128A** is substantially as wide as the conductive pillar **128B**.

In some embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** are made of or include copper (Cu), gold (Au), platinum (Pt), titanium (Ti), nickel (Ni), aluminum (Al), one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** are made of pure elemental copper, copper containing some impurities, or copper alloys containing minor amounts of other elements. For example, the copper alloys may contain tantalum, indium, tin, zinc, manganese, chromium, titanium, germanium, strontium, platinum, magnesium, aluminum, zirconium, one or more other suitable elements, or a combination thereof.

In some embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** are formed using an electroplating process, an elec-

troless plating process, a CVD process, a PVD process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the UBM layer **122** functions as an electroplating seed layer. A suitable conductive material, such as copper, is electroplated on the UBM layer **122** to form the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** are formed simultaneously. In some other embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** are formed separately.

Afterwards, a solder material is formed over the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, as shown in FIG. 1H in accordance with some embodiments. The solder material forms solder elements **130A** and **130B**. In some embodiments, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are in direct contact with the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, respectively. The solder elements **130A** and **130B** may be made of a tin-containing material. The tin-containing material may further include lead (Pb), silver (Ag), bismuth (Bi), copper (Cu), gold (Au), aluminum (Al), arsenic (As), iron (Fe), nickel (Ni), antimony (Sb), one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some other embodiments, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are lead-free. In some embodiments, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are formed over the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** using an electroplating process, an electroless plating process, a CVD process, a PVD process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. In some embodiments, a barrier layer (not shown) is formed over the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** before the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are formed. In these cases, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** may not be in direct contact with the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, respectively. The barrier layer may be used to prevent ions (such as copper ions) in the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** from diffusing into the solder elements **130A** and **130B**. The prevention of ion diffusion (such as copper diffusion) may increase the reliability and bonding strength. In some embodiments, the barrier layer is made of or includes nickel (Ni), gold (Au), tin-lead (SnPb), silver (Ag), palladium (Pd), indium (In), nickel-palladium-gold (NiPdAu), nickel-gold (NiAu), one or more other suitable materials, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the barrier layer is formed using an electroplating process, an electroless plating process, a PVD process, a CVD process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1I, the mask layer **124** is removed, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the mask layer **124** is removed using a stripping process, an ashing process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof.

As shown in FIG. 1I, the UBM layer **122** is then patterned, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the UBM layer **122** is patterned using an etching process with the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** and the solder elements **130A** and **130B** as an etching mask. The etching process may include a dry etching process, a wet etching process, or a combination thereof. After the etching process, the portions of the UBM layer **122** not covered by the etching mask are removed. As a result, the insulating layer **118** is exposed after the etching process. The patterning of the UBM layer **122** may help to prevent short circuiting between the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**.

As shown in FIG. 1J, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are reflowed to form solder bumps **130A'** and **130B'** over the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, in accordance with some

embodiments. In some embodiments, the solder elements **130A** and **130B** are reflowed at a reflow temperature ranging from about 200 degrees C. to about 280 degrees C. In some embodiments, the solder bumps **130A'** and **130B'** have curved upper surfaces. The solder bump **130A'** and the conductive pillar **128A** may together function as a first conductive bump, and the solder bump **130B'** and the conductive pillar **128B** may together function as a second conductive bump.

In some embodiments, the semiconductor substrate **100** is a semiconductor wafer. In some embodiments, a dicing process is applied to separate the semiconductor substrate **100** (such as a semiconductor wafer) and the elements thereabove into multiple separated semiconductor chips (or semiconductor dies) **10**. One of the semiconductor chips **10** is shown in FIG. 1J. In some embodiments, the semiconductor chip **10** is packaged in a package structure. Alternatively, in some other embodiments, the dicing process is not performed. In these cases, the entirety of the semiconductor substrate **100** (such as a semiconductor wafer) may be packaged in a package structure.

As shown in FIG. 1J, the conductive pillar **128A** has a protruding portion **127A**. The protruding portion **127A** extends towards the semiconductor substrate **100** from a lower surface (such as the lower surface of the conductive pillar **128A** extending over the top surface of the insulating layer **118**) of the conductive pillar **128A**. Similarly, the conductive pillar **128B** has a protruding portion **127B**. The protruding portion **127B** extends towards the semiconductor substrate **100** from a lower surface (such as the lower surface of the conductive pillar **128B** that extends over the top surface of the insulating layer **118**) of the conductive pillar **128B**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** have vertical sidewalls, and the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** have inclined sidewalls.

FIG. 2 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 2 shows a plan view of the semiconductor chip **10** shown in FIG. 1J. For clarity, the solder bumps **130A'** and **130B'** are not illustrated in FIG. 2. The profiles of the bottoms of the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** are illustrated using dashed lines in FIG. 2.

As shown in FIGS. 1J and 2, the conductive pillar **128A** is closer to the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor substrate **100** than the conductive pillar **128B**, in accordance with some embodiments. The conductive pillar **128B** is positioned over an edge portion (or a corner portion) of the semiconductor substrate **100** of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some cases, the edge portion means the region where one row of conductive pillars (that is adjacent to the edge of the semiconductor chip **10**) are positioned. In some other cases, the edge portion means the region where two rows of conductive pillars (that are adjacent to the edge of the semiconductor chip **10**) are positioned. As shown in FIGS. 1J and 2, the bottoms of the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** have the widths W_A and W_B , respectively. In some embodiments, the width W_B is greater than the width W_A . In some embodiments, the bottoms of the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** have circular profiles, as shown in FIG. 2.

As shown in FIGS. 1J and 2, the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** have widths W_A' and W_B' , respectively. In some embodiments, the widths W_A' and W_B' are the maximum widths of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, respectively. In some embodiments, the width W_A' is substantially

equal to the width W_B' . In some embodiments, the top view of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** have circular profiles, as shown in FIG. 2.

In some embodiments, the available routing area at the edge portion of the semiconductor chip **10** is larger than that at the inner portion. Because the outer area or the edge portion of the semiconductor chip **10** has less “cross-line” requirement, more available space is provided to enlarge the opening **120B**. As a result, the protruding portions **127B** are allowed to be formed wider than the protruding portion **127A**. Therefore, the interface area between the conductive pillar **128B** and the conductive feature **116B** is larger than the interface area between the conductive pillar **128A** and the conductive feature **116A**. The wider protruding portions **127B** may help to reduce the stress near the conductive pillars **128B** that are positioned at the edge portion (and/or the corner portion) of the semiconductor chip **10**. Cracks and/or delamination are reduced or prevented from occurring near the conductive pillars **128B**. The reliability and performance of the semiconductor device structure are greatly improved.

As mentioned above, in some embodiments, the ratio (W_A'/W_B') of the width W_A' to the width W_B' may be in a range from about 0.01 to about 1 or in a range from about 0.05 to about 0.95. In some cases, if the ratio (W_A'/W_B') is smaller than about 0.01 (or 0.05), the protruding portion **127B** might be too wide. The routing of the conductive paths near the edge portion of the semiconductor chip **10** may become too challenging. In some other cases, if the ratio (W_A'/W_B') is greater than about 1 (or 0.95), the protruding portion **127A** might be too wide. The routing of the conductive paths near the inner portion of the semiconductor chip **10** may become too challenging. Alternatively, if the ratio (W_A'/W_B') is greater than about 1 (or 0.95), the protruding portion **127B** might not be wide enough to sustain a subsequent bonding process. The reliability and quality of the conductive pillar **128B** might be negatively affected.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 3 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 3 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillar **128B** is not as wide as the conductive pillar **128A**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillar **128B** is wider than the conductive pillar **128A**. The width W_B' of the conductive pillar **128B** is greater than the width W_A' of the conductive pillar **128A**. In some embodiments, by fine-tuning the shapes and sizes of the openings **126A** and **126B** as illustrated in FIG. 1G, the shapes and sizes of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** may be modified according to the requirements. The wider conductive pillar **128B** may have greater strength to sustain a subsequent bonding process.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 4 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 4 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some embodiments, there are two or more rows of the conductive pillars **128B** having the wider protruding portions **127B** near the edge portion and/or corner portions of the semiconductor chip **10**.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 5 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 5 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In

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some embodiments, the semiconductor chip **10** further includes one or more conductive pillars **128C**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillar **128B** is between the conductive pillar **128A** and **128C**. The material and formation method of the conductive pillars **128C** may be the same as or similar to those of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**. In some embodiments, the conductive pillar **128C** is substantially as wide as the conductive pillar **128A** or **128B**, as shown in FIG. 5. In some embodiments, the top views of the conductive pillars **128A**, **128B**, and **128C** have circular profiles.

In some embodiments, similar to the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B**, the conductive pillar **128C** has a protruding portion **127C**. Similar to the protruding portion **127A** or **127B**, the protruding portion **127C** extends towards the semiconductor substrate **100** from a lower surface of the conductive pillar **128C**. In some embodiments, the protruding portion **127C** is wider than the protruding portion **127B**, as shown in FIG. 5. As shown in FIG. 5, the bottom of the protruding portion **127C** has a width W_C that is greater than the width W_B of the bottom of the protruding portion **127B**.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 6 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 6 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some embodiments, by fine-tuning the shapes and sizes of the openings **120A** and **120B** as illustrated in FIG. 1F, the shapes and sizes of the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** may be modified according to the requirements.

As shown in FIG. 6, the bottoms of the protruding portions **127A** and **127B** have oval profiles, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 6, the bottom of the protruding portions **127A** has a long axis L_A with the width W_A . The bottom of the protruding portions **127B** has a long axis L_B with the width W_B . In some embodiments, the long axis L_A is substantially parallel to the long axis L_B , as shown in FIG. 6.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 7 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 7 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some embodiments, the long axis L_A is not parallel to the long axis L_B . In some embodiments, the long axis L_A and the long axis L_B extend along different directions. In some embodiments, the long axis L_A and the long axis L_B extend along directions pointing to the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor chip **10**. The long axis L_A and the long axis L_B are aligned with the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor chip **10**, as shown in FIG. 7.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 8 is a plan view showing a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, FIG. 8 shows a top view of the semiconductor chip **10**. In some embodiments, the top views of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** have oval profiles. The long axis of the top views of the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** may be aligned with the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor chip **10**, as shown in FIG. 8.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. 9 is a cross-sectional view of a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments,

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a first conductive via (such as the conductive via with the width W_1) formed between the conductive pillar **128A** and the semiconductor substrate **100** is narrower than a second conductive via (such as the conductive via with the width W_2) formed between the conductive pillar **128B** and the semiconductor substrate **100**. The wider conductive via near the edge portion and/or corner portion of the semiconductor substrate **100** may help to reduce the bonding stress during a subsequent bonding process. The performance and reliability of the semiconductor device structure may be improved.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. The semiconductor chip **10** as illustrated in FIGS. 1J, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, and/or 9 may be integrated into a package structure. FIGS. 10A-10C are cross-sectional views of various stages of a process for forming a portion of a package structure, in accordance with some embodiments.

As shown in FIG. 10A, a redistribution structure **200** is formed or provided, in accordance with some embodiments. The redistribution structure **200** may be a package substrate (such as a circuit board), an interposer substrate (such as a semiconductor interposer or a polymer interposer), an interconnection structure of a wafer, a polymer-containing interconnection structure formed over a carrier substrate, or the like. In some embodiments, the redistribution structure **200** includes conductive pads **202** that may be used to receive and hold one or more semiconductor chips.

As shown in FIG. 10B, semiconductor chips **10** and **10'** are bonded to the conductive pads **202**, in accordance with some embodiments. The semiconductor chips **10** and **10'** may have the same or similar structures as illustrated in FIGS. 1J, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, and/or 9. Before the bonding of the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**, solder elements and/or flux materials may be formed over the conductive pads **202** to assist in the bonding process. The bonding elements over the conductive pads **202** may be reflowed together with the solder bumps **130A'** and **130B'** of the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**. As a result, solder bumps **204** are formed to affix the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'** on the redistribution structure **200**.

The bonding process mentioned above involves applying force between the redistribution structure **200** and the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**. Because the conductive pillars **128B** have the wider protruding portions, the bonding stress near the conductive pillars **128B** is significantly reduced. Cracks and/or delamination issues are thus prevented or reduced. The performance and reliability of the package structure are greatly improved.

As shown in FIG. 10C, an underfill material **206** is formed to surround and protect the conductive pillars **128A** and **128B** and the solder bumps **204**, in accordance with some embodiments. The underfill material **206** may be made of or include a polymer material, such as an epoxy-based resin with fillers dispersed therein. The fillers may include fibers (such as silica fibers and/or carbon-containing fibers), particles (such as silica particles and/or carbon-containing particles), or a combination thereof.

Afterwards, a protective layer **208** is formed over the redistribution structure **200** to surround and protect the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**, as shown in FIG. 10C in accordance with some embodiments. In some embodiments, the protective layer **208** is in physical contact with the redistribution structure **200**.

However, embodiments of the disclosure are not limited thereto. Many variations and/or modifications can be made

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to embodiments of the disclosure. In some other embodiments, the underfill material **206** is not formed.

In some embodiments, the protective layer **208** is made of or includes an insulating material such as a molding material. The molding material may include a polymer material, such as an epoxy-based resin with fillers dispersed therein. The fillers may include fibers (such as silica fibers and/or carbon-containing fibers), particles (such as silica particles and/or carbon-containing particles), or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, the distribution density of the fillers in the protective layer **208** is greater than the distribution density of the fillers in the underfill material **206**. In some embodiments, the weight percentage of the fillers in the protective layer **208** is greater than the weight percentage of the fillers in the underfill material **206**. The profiles, sizes, and/or materials of the fillers in the protective layer **208** and the underfill material **206** may be different from each other.

In some embodiments, a molding material (such as a liquid molding material) is introduced or injected to cover the redistribution structure **200** and the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**. In some embodiments, a thermal process is then used to cure the liquid molding material and to transform it into the protective layer **208**. In some embodiments, a planarization process is performed to the protective layer **208** to improve the flatness of the protective layer **208**. For example, the planarization process may include a grinding process, a CMP process, a dry polishing process, one or more other applicable processes, or a combination thereof. In some embodiments, after the planarization process, the top surface of the protective layer **208** is substantially level with the surfaces of the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'**.

Because the conductive pillars formed at the edge portions (and/or the corner portions) of the semiconductor chips **10** and **10'** have the wider protruding portions, these conductive pillars may have greater strength to sustain the bonding stress and/or the warpage stress. The reliability and quality of the package structure are improved.

Many variations and/or modifications can be made to embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. **11** is a cross-sectional view of a portion of a semiconductor device structure, in accordance with some embodiments. As mentioned above, in some embodiments, the conductive feature **116B** is wider than the conductive feature **116A**. As shown in FIG. **11**, the conductive feature **116B** (that may function as an outer conductive pad) has a width W_O . The conductive feature **116A** (that may function as an inner conductive pad) has a width W_I . The width W_O is greater than the W_I . The conductive feature **116B** (that is wider) may have a greater strength to sustain higher stress at the edge region (or the outer region).

Embodiments of the disclosure form a semiconductor device structure with an inner conductive pillar and an outer conductive pillar. The inner conductive pillar is closer to the center portion (or the center point) of the semiconductor device structure, and the outer conductive pillar is closer to an edge portion of the semiconductor device structure. The inner conductive pillar and the outer conductive pillar respectively have a first protruding portion and a second protruding portion. The first protruding portion and the second protruding portion extend towards a semiconductor substrate of the semiconductor device structure. The second protruding portion is designed to be wider than the first protruding portion. The second protruding portion that is wider may help to reduce the stress near the conductive pillars that are positioned at the edge portion (and/or the corner portion) and/or help to sustain the warpage stress.

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Cracks and/or delamination are thus prevented or reduced. The reliability and performance of the semiconductor device structure are greatly improved.

In accordance with some embodiments, a semiconductor device structure is provided. The semiconductor device structure includes a semiconductor substrate and an interconnection structure over the semiconductor substrate. The semiconductor device structure also includes a first conductive pillar over the interconnection structure. The first conductive pillar has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the first conductive pillar. The semiconductor device structure further includes a second conductive pillar over the interconnection structure. The second conductive pillar has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the second conductive pillar. The first conductive pillar is closer to a center portion of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive pillar. A bottom of the second protruding portion is wider than a bottom of the first protruding portion.

In accordance with some embodiments, a package structure is provided. The package structure includes a redistribution structure and a semiconductor chip bonded to the redistribution structure. The semiconductor chip includes a semiconductor substrate and an interconnection structure over the semiconductor substrate. The semiconductor chip also includes a first conductive bump over the interconnection structure, and the first conductive bump has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the first conductive bump. The semiconductor chip further includes a second conductive bump over the interconnection structure, and the second conductive bump has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the second conductive bump. The first conductive bump is closer to a center portion of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive bump, and the second protruding portion is wider than the first protruding portion. The package structure also includes a protective layer surrounding the semiconductor chip.

In accordance with some embodiments, a method for forming a semiconductor device structure is provided. The method includes forming an interconnection structure over a semiconductor substrate. The method also includes forming a first conductive feature and a second conductive feature over the interconnection structure. The first conductive feature is closer to a center portion of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive feature. The method further includes forming an insulating layer over the first conductive feature and the second conductive feature. In addition, the method includes forming a first opening and a second opening in the insulating layer to expose the first conductive feature and the second conductive feature. An exposed area of the second conductive feature is larger than an exposed area of the first conductive feature. The method includes forming a first conductive pillar over the first conductive feature, and the first conductive pillar extends into the first opening. The method also includes forming a second conductive pillar over the second conductive feature, and the second conductive pillar extends into the second opening.

The foregoing outlines features of several embodiments so that those skilled in the art may better understand the aspects of the present disclosure. Those skilled in the art should appreciate that they may readily use the present disclosure as a basis for designing or modifying other processes and structures for carrying out the same purposes

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and/or achieving the same advantages of the embodiments introduced herein. Those skilled in the art should also realize that such equivalent constructions do not depart from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure, and that they may make various changes, substitutions, and alterations herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

What is claimed is:

1. A semiconductor device structure, comprising:
 - a semiconductor substrate;
 - a first conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the first conductive structure has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the first conductive structure; and
 - a second conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive structure is substantially as wide as the first conductive structure, the second conductive structure has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the second conductive structure, the first conductive structure is closer to a center point of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive structure, the second protruding portion is wider than the first protruding portion, and bottoms of the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are substantially level with each other.
2. The package structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein tops of the first conductive structure and the second conductive structure are substantially level with each other.
3. The package structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein the first protruding portion has a first slanted sidewall, and the second protruding portion has a second slanted sidewall.
4. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 1, further comprising:
 - a third conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the third conductive structure has a third protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate from a lower surface of the third conductive structure, and the second conductive structure is between the first conductive structure and the third conductive structure.
5. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 4, wherein a bottom of the third protruding portion is substantially as wide as the bottom of the second protruding portion.
6. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 4, wherein a bottom of the third protruding portion is wider than the bottom of the second protruding portion.
7. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 1, wherein the bottom of the first protruding portion has a first oval profile, the bottom of the first protruding portion has a first long axis, the bottom of the second protruding portion has a second oval profile, and the bottom of the second protruding portion has a second long axis.
8. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 7, wherein the first long axis is substantially parallel to the second long axis.
9. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 7, wherein the first long axis and the second long axis are not parallel to each other, and the first long axis and the second long axis are aligned with the center point of the semiconductor substrate.
10. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 1, further comprising:

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- a first conductive via between the first conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate; and
 - a second conductive via between the second conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive via is wider than the first conductive via.
11. A semiconductor device structure, comprising:
 - a semiconductor substrate;
 - a first conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the first conductive structure has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate, and a top of the first conductive structure is wider than the first protruding portion; and
 - a second conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive structure is substantially as wide as the first conductive structure, the second conductive structure has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate, a top of the second conductive structure is wider than the second protruding portion, the second protruding portion is wider than the first protruding portion, and tops of the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are substantially level with each other, wherein the first conductive structure is closer to a center portion of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive structure.
 12. The package structure as claimed in claim 11, wherein bottoms of the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are substantially level with each other.
 13. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 11, further comprising:
 - a first conductive via between the first conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate; and
 - a second conductive via between the second conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive via is wider than the first conductive via.
 14. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 13, wherein the first conductive via is directly below the first protruding portion, and the second conductive via is laterally spaced apart from the second protruding portion.
 15. A semiconductor device structure, comprising:
 - a semiconductor substrate;
 - a first conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the first conductive structure has a first protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate, and a top of the first conductive structure is wider than the first protruding portion;
 - a second conductive structure over the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive structure is substantially as wide as the first conductive structure, the second conductive structure has a second protruding portion extending towards the semiconductor substrate, a top of the second conductive structure is wider than the second protruding portion, the second protruding portion is wider than the first protruding portion, and bottoms of the first protruding portion and the second protruding portion are substantially aligned with each other;
 - a first conductive via between the first conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate; and
 - a second conductive via between the second conductive structure and the semiconductor substrate, wherein the second conductive via is wider than the first conductive via.
 16. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim 15, wherein the first conductive via is directly below

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the first protruding portion, and the second conductive via is laterally spaced apart from the second protruding portion.

17. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim **16**, wherein the first conductive structure extends across opposite sidewalls of the first conductive via. 5

18. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim **15**, wherein the first conductive via is laterally spaced apart from the first protruding portion, and the second conductive via is laterally spaced apart from the second protruding portion. 10

19. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim **11**, wherein the first protruding portion has a slanted sidewall.

20. The semiconductor device structure as claimed in claim **15**, wherein the first conductive structure is closer to a center portion of the semiconductor substrate than the second conductive structure. 15

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